

Katrina Engelsted

Boulder, Colorado · open to relocating to the Roaring Fork Valley

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July 28, 2026

Becca Schild

Executive Director
Roaring Fork Outdoor Volunteers
520 S. Third St, Suite 32
Carbondale, CO 81623

RE: DEVELOPMENT COORDINATOR

Dear Becca,

I'm writing to apply for the Development Coordinator role at RFOV. I'll admit there's a personal thread pulling me toward this one beyond the job description: I went to high school at HMI, where I understand you taught and were part of the gap program. I don't know if our paths ever actually crossed, but growing up around that kind of wilderness-education community is a big part of why public-lands stewardship has stayed close to me ever since — and why an organization built around mobilizing people to do the restoration work themselves, rather than fund it from a distance, is one I'd genuinely like to work for.

That thread runs through my own education, too. At Colgate I taught whitewater canoeing, backpacking, and trail maintenance through the outdoor education program, and spent some of my best college summers on trail crews in the hills of New Hampshire. More recently I've become a PMBIA-certified mountain bike coach (Whistler, 2023), and every season since I've been recruiting, training, and running groups of riders through skills progressions — the same core skills the job description asks for in recruiting and supervising volunteer stewardship projects. **This part of the role isn't a stretch for me — it's something I already do most weekends.**

The other half of the role — donor database management, reporting, and fundraising communications — maps closely onto fifteen years of analyst and marketing-technology work. At Lytics I built customer-data segments and delivery pipelines for enterprise clients; at Homebot I designed the data schema behind a messy real-estate dataset and built the email product that got millions of homeowners to actually open and act on a mortgage email; and at a small mountain-town retailer I cleaned up inconsistent POS and product data and built the reporting a small organization actually needs. I haven't worked in Salesforce specifically, but I've gotten fluent in a new data platform on the job at every stop in my career, and I'd expect the same here.

None of this is a career pivot for me so much as a career homecoming. I went into nonprofit work straight out of college, with internships at the Humanitarian OpenStreetMap Team and the Bonobo Conservation Initiative, and an honors thesis in spatial statistics on alternative land economies. More recently I've been a founding technical advisor at a small water-utility conservation startup. I believe in conservation for its own sake — for the wildlife that doesn't get a say in how land gets used, and for the kids who'll inherit whatever shape we leave these landscapes in.

I'm currently based in Boulder and would relocate to the Roaring Fork Valley for this role — it's a landscape I already know and care about, not one I'd be discovering for the first time. I'm open to either full-time or part-time, whatever structure works best for RFOV. A longer, line-by-line version of this letter mapping the job description against my background is at engelsted.co/rfov.html, alongside my full résumé.

Thank you for considering my application. I'd welcome the chance to talk — about the role, or just about trail work.

Sincerely,

Katrina Engelsted

BOULDER, COLORADO